# CRED – “Gamification and Credit – Card Repayment Behaviuor”

## Introduction

Financial technology (FinTech) has transformed the way people manage money, make payments, borrow, save, and invest. One interesting development is the use of technology to encourage better financial habits. CRED is a FinTech platform that focuses on credit-card users and provides rewards and benefits for responsible payment behaviour.

CRED combines financial services with technology, rewards, and gamification to encourage users to pay their credit-card bills on time. By offering rewards for timely payments, the platform attempts to make an otherwise routine financial activity more engaging. This approach shows how FinTech companies can influence consumer behaviour while providing digital financial services.

This case study examines CRED's business model and its use of gamification to influence credit-card repayment behaviour. It focuses on how rewards and digital engagement can encourage timely payments, improve financial awareness, and influence users' interaction with credit. The study also considers the benefits and challenges of using technology and rewards to promote responsible financial behaviour.

Overall, the case study aims to understand how CRED uses FinTech innovation and behavioural strategies to create a different approach to credit management and how this model has influenced the relationship between young consumers and digital financial services.

# Objectives

- To study the role of gamification features such as rewards, points, offers, and achievement-based incentives in encouraging timely credit-card bill payments.
- To examine whether CRED's reward-based system motivates users to repay their credit-card bills on time.
- To analyse the relationship between user engagement with CRED and repayment behaviour.
- To understand whether gamification can encourage users to develop regular and responsible credit-management habits.

# Review of Literature

**Hamari, Koivisto & Sarsa (2014)**The study reviewed research on gamification and found that game elements can improve user motivation, engagement and participation. This provides a theoretical basis for studying how reward-based features in financial applications may influence user behaviour.

**Ching & Hayashi (2010)**The researchers examined payment-card reward programmes and found that rewards can influence consumers' payment-method choices. This suggests that financial incentives may play an important role in shaping payment behaviour.

**Bursztyn et al. (2019)**The study examined behavioural interventions related to credit-card debt repayment. It showed that behavioural messages and interventions can influence repayment decisions and reduce problematic repayment patterns.

**Hendy, Slonim & Atalay (2021)**The researchers studied advice, repayment targets and financial incentives in credit-card repayment. They found that combining information with financial incentives had a

stronger effect on repayment behaviour than information alone.

**Raza et al. (2024)**This research investigated gamification in financial-service applications. The findings showed that gamification positively affects user experience and customer engagement. The study also found that immediate rewards can have a stronger influence on users than delayed rewards.

**Agrawal & Sharma (2025)**The researchers studied 557 financial-app users in India and examined the relationship between gamification and financial behaviour. They found that gamification can strengthen the effects of financial planning and self-efficacy on financial behaviour. Features such as real-time feedback and progress tracking were particularly relevant.

**Yavie & Mutiaz (2026)**This systematic literature review analysed 17 empirical studies on gamification in digital financial applications. It found that points, rewards, badges, leaderboards and progress tracking are commonly used and can improve engagement and financial behaviour.

**Rizwan, Malik & Hussain (2026)**Their systematic review examined 43 peer-reviewed studies on gamification in finance. The study found that gamification can influence spending, saving and investment behaviour and improve user engagement. However, it also highlighted concerns such as user fatigue and potentially manipulative designs.

**Misara et al. (2026)**The researchers reviewed gamification across modern financial ecosystems, including mobile banking, digital payments and investment platforms. Their findings indicate that rewards, challenges, leaderboards and interactive feedback can influence financial intentions, engagement and financial well-being.

**Literature on digital nudges and credit repayment (2026)**Recent research on digital financial environments suggests that the way repayment information and repayment options are presented can influence credit-card repayment decisions. This supports the idea that app design and behavioural nudges can affect repayment behaviour.

# Company Profile

CRED is an Indian fintech company founded by Kunal Shah in 2018. It was created to encourage responsible credit-card payment behaviour by rewarding members who pay their credit-card bills on time.

CRED operates as a members-only platform mainly targeting creditworthy credit-card users. It provides services such as credit-card bill payments, credit-score tracking, expense management, rewards, UPI payments, lending and other financial services.

One of CRED's important features is gamification. Users receive rewards, coins, cashback and access to exclusive experiences for using the platform and making eligible payments. This makes the normally routine activity of paying bills more engaging.

# Business Model

CRED follows a platform-based fintech business model.

1. **Attract creditworthy users**
   CRED targets users with good credit profiles.
2. **Encourage timely payments**
   Users pay their credit-card bills through the CRED platform.
3. **Provide rewards**
   Users receive coins, cashback, rewards and access to exclusive experiences.
4. **Increase user engagement**
   Gamification encourages users to return to the platform and interact with its services.
5. **Offer additional financial products**
   CRED has expanded beyond credit-card payments into lending, payments, insurance, wealth and lifestyle services.
6. **Connect brands with customers**
   CRED provides businesses with access to its premium customer base through marketing, rewards, CRED Pay and its shopping platform.

# Revenue Model

CRED generates revenue through multiple activities rather than depending only on credit-card bill payments.

**1. Lending Services**

CRED facilitates loans through partner banks and NBFCs and acts as a lending service provider.

**2. Brand Partnerships and Advertising**

Brands can partner with CRED for marketing campaigns and to reach its high-spending customer base.

**3. CRED Pay**

CRED provides payment solutions through UPI and online checkout, combined with rewards and offers.

**4. Shopping and Lifestyle Services**

CRED has a members-focused shopping platform where brands can showcase products to CRED users.

**5. Financial Services**

The company has expanded into areas such as wealth, insurance and other financial products.

# Analysis

# SWOT

The impact of CRED's gamification on credit-card repayment behaviour can be evaluated using SWOT Analysis, which identifies the strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats associated with the platform. This analysis helps understand how CRED uses rewards and technology to encourage timely credit-card repayments while facing challenges in the competitive fintech industry.

## 1. Strengths:

### (i) Gamification and Rewards:

CRED uses coins, cashback, rewards, and exclusive offers to make credit-card bill payments more engaging and attractive.

### (ii) Encourages Timely Repayment:

The reward-based system encourages users to pay their credit-card bills on time and promotes responsible repayment behaviour.

**(iii) User-Friendly Platform:**

CRED provides a simple and convenient digital platform for credit-card bill payments and other financial services.

**2. Weaknesses:**

**(i) Limited Target Customers:**

CRED mainly focuses on creditworthy credit-card users, which limits its customer base.

**(ii) Dependence on Rewards:**

Some users may continue using the platform mainly because of rewards and cashback rather than the financial services themselves.

**(iii) High Customer Acquisition Costs:**

Providing attractive rewards and marketing campaigns can increase the company's operating and customer-acquisition costs.

**3. Opportunities:**

**(i) Growth of Credit-Card Usage:**

The increasing use of credit cards in India provides CRED with opportunities to attract more users.

**(ii) Expansion of Financial Services:**

CRED can expand its lending, investment, insurance, wealth-management, and other financial services.

**(iii) Personalised Rewards:**

CRED can use customer data and technology to provide more personalised rewards and financial recommendations.

**4. Threats:**

**(i) Intense Competition:**

CRED faces competition from banks, fintech companies, payment platforms, and other financial-service providers.

**(ii) Cybersecurity Risks:**

Fraud, data breaches, phishing, and other cyber threats can affect customer trust and platform usage.

**(iii) Regulatory Changes:**

Changes in RBI regulations and government policies may affect CRED's lending, payment, and financial services.

# Findings

- Gamification makes credit-card payments more engaging.
- Rewards can encourage users to make timely bill payments.
- CRED uses rewards and exclusive benefits to increase customer engagement.
- The platform focuses strongly on creditworthy customers.
- CRED has expanded from credit-card payments into a broader fintech ecosystem.
- Gamification helps differentiate CRED from traditional bill-payment platforms.
- Brand partnerships provide additional opportunities for customer engagement and monetisation.
- Lending has become an important part of CRED's business strategy.
- CRED's model shows how behavioural incentives can be combined with financial technology.
- The company still faces the challenge of balancing customer rewards, growth and profitability.

# Conclusion

CRED has created a unique fintech model by combining credit-card payments, rewards and gamification. Instead of treating bill payment as a routine financial activity, CRED makes it more engaging through rewards, coins and exclusive benefits. This can encourage users to pay their credit-card bills on time and interact more frequently with the platform.

The case study shows that gamification can influence financial behaviour by providing positive incentives. At the same time, CRED's expansion into lending, payments, shopping and other financial services shows its attempt to build a broader fintech ecosystem. Overall, CRED is an interesting example of how technology, rewards and behavioural strategies can be combined to influence credit-card repayment behaviour.

# References


- CRED. About CRED – Company Overview. Official CRED Website.
- CRED. CRED Pay – Digital Payment Services. Official CRED Website.
- CRED. Lending and Financial Services – Other Disclosures. Official CRED Website.
- CRED. Privacy Policy and Terms of Service. Official CRED Website.
- CRED Newsroom. CRED – Company News and Updates. Official CRED Newsroom.
- Reserve Bank of India (RBI). Banking and Financial Services Reports. RBI Publications.
- National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI). UPI Product Statistics and Digital Payment Information.
- Inc42. CRED – Company Profile, Business Model and Financial Information.
- Economic Times. CRED – Fintech Industry and Business Updates. *The Economic Times*.
- Business Standard. CRED and India's Fintech Industry – Business and Financial Reports.